

Gaps. Common trading lore says a breakout day gap helps performance. With wedges, it's a mixed bag. Gaps help after a downward breakout but not after an upward one. Notice that the gap size is twice as large after a downward breakout. The size of the gap might be related to downward moves having higher velocity than upward ones, but that's a guess.

[Table 13.5](#) shows pattern size statistics.

Height. Tall patterns outperform short ones for both breakout directions. In fact, height is the best predictor of future performance. Unfortunately, because we're dealing with probabilities, we can't say for sure if a tall wedge you're considering trading will outperform a short one, but on average, tall ones perform better.

To determine if a wedge is tall, compute the height from the highest price at the pattern's start to the lowest one at the pattern's end. Divide the height by the breakout price (the price where the stock closes above or below one of the trendlines). If the result is higher than that shown in the table for the respective breakout direction, then you have a tall pattern.

Width. Wide patterns generally perform better than narrow ones and that's what we see here. I measured the width of each pattern from start to end in calendar days (not price bars) and compared the result to the median width shown in the table.